

to have the right approach. The more tools and knowledge a user has about the software, the better the manipulation and organisation of data.

Understanding Formatting in Excel

Formatting can be done with a variety of tools within Excel. You can do so via conditional formatting, which only captures the essential information within the domain. You can also do so with linking different sheets, having data validation and so on. Formatting revolves around the core objective of what you're trying to accomplish with the data.

While formatting is viewed as a secondary tool, it should be viewed as a primary insight driver. Through formatting, you're able to get more meaningful and insightful data.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1		Smith	Jones	Michaels	Hancock	Totals	
2	January	\$4,212.64	\$6,795.69	\$2,148.78	\$4,611.14	\$17,768.25	
3	February	\$3,194.08	\$3,449.36	\$9,020.05	\$7,401.84	\$23,065.33	
4	March	\$3,000.00	\$2,332.71	\$8,507.84	\$4,224.17	\$18,064.72	
5	April	\$2,500.00	\$2,804.82	\$9,078.84	\$7,620.23	\$22,003.89	
6	May	\$2,989.75	\$2,504.17	\$4,263.65	\$2,706.73	\$12,464.30	
7	June	\$3,200.34	\$5,426.36	\$5,325.03	\$4,494.94	\$18,446.68	
8	July	\$6,912.61	\$4,229.14	\$6,361.90	\$5,936.46	\$23,440.11	
9	August	\$4,596.56	\$5,936.79	\$3,222.88	\$3,304.52	\$17,060.75	
10	September	\$7,529.99	\$7,673.70	\$2,862.51	\$3,831.45	\$21,897.65	
11	October		840.23	\$2,489.00	\$6,686.40	\$24,203.70	
12	November		209.72	\$5,197.35	\$3,495.50	\$13,987.57	
13	December		578.77	\$938.35	\$7,961.63	\$17,134.76	
14	January		781.45	\$59,416.19	\$62,275.01	\$229,537.71	
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Formatting across different cells

Cell Formatting in Excel

Cell formatting can be done using the default tools available in Excel. Right-click on the actual cell and then go to Format Cells. From there, you can choose from a variety of options like currency/percentage and decimal and symbols.

You can provide universal formatting as well, with an overarching approach to formatting multiple cells. If you want to distinguish a particular unit or deep dive into smaller digits, you can do so with cell formatting. You can also design a more robust data sheet with information being stored behind formatting.